

A NORTH END THAT WORKS.

A practical plan for stronger infrastructure, fairer municipal spending and accountable leadership.

—
**A PLAN
BUILT ON
RESULTS.**

WARD 5 / GRANTHAM / 2026



DUNSIN FAKOREDE

FOR CITY COUNCILLOR | WARD 5 – GRANTHAM

Building a Stronger, Safer & More Connected Ward 5.

ST. CATHARINES • ELECTION DAY: OCTOBER 26, 2026

www.dunsin4stcward5councillor.ca

A practical plan for Ward 5 - Grantham. Authorized by the Dunsin Fakorede campaign.

OUR COMMITMENT

Experience with purpose

Why I am asking Ward 5 residents to trust me with their vote.



WARD 5 RESIDENTS AND COMMUNITY CONVERSATIONS | CAMPAIGN PHOTOGRAPHS

Ward 5 is where neighbours build lives, raise families, run businesses and look after one another. I am running because the everyday concerns I have heard at doors and community meetings deserve more than reassuring words. Residents want to know when a road will be repaired, why a basement flooded, how tax dollars are spent and whether City Hall is listening.

I am a project manager with a background in mechanical engineering and construction delivery. I understand how to evaluate risk, monitor budgets, ask difficult questions and track work from planning through delivery. Those practical skills can help strengthen the decisions made for Grantham—but they mean little without listening first.

The standard I will bring

I will ask for evidence before endorsing major spending, insist that infrastructure problems are evaluated against real risks, and explain the choices facing residents—even when the answers are difficult.

I will distinguish the actions I can take directly from proposals that require Council votes, technical studies or funding partnerships.

A councillor who stays present

Representation must continue between elections. I will provide regular ward updates, maintain clear contact channels and share what I supported, what Council decided and what happens next.

My priorities are practical: flood resilience, safer movement around our neighbourhood, dependable services and a municipal budget that treats taxpayers with respect.

Candidate background: project manager with a background in mechanical engineering.

THE DIRECTION

Three priorities. One accountable plan.

The issues that demand the clearest action from Ward 5 representation.

01

RESILIENT INFRASTRUCTURE

1. Fix what puts homes at risk

Flooding and aging infrastructure cannot be managed through emergency responses alone. We need evidence-led assessments, clear project sequencing, maintenance, and long-term investment.

- Ask for a Ward 5 infrastructure risk and condition review.
- Track drainage, sewer, sidewalk and road priorities together.
- Publish progress and explain deferrals.

02

RESPECT FOR TAXPAYERS

2. Make spending understandable

Taxpayers deserve proof that spending decisions are necessary, affordable and well managed. I will explore a four-year cap on increases to the City-controlled portion of residential property taxes, subject to a lawful, fully funded plan.

- Review procurement and recurring costs.
- Protect essential services and infrastructure funding.

03

OPEN AND ACCESSIBLE COUNCIL

3. Restore accessible representation

I will communicate how Council decisions affect Ward 5 and be clear when a proposal succeeds, fails or is delayed. Residents deserve direct answers, not campaign-season attention alone.

Important boundary

A councillor advocates, brings motions, evaluates proposals and votes with colleagues. Major funding, operating standards and projects depend on Council, staff, partner governments and the approved budget.

This manifesto expands the existing ten-commitment platform while prioritizing infrastructure, taxes and accountability. See pages 4–12 for proposed actions.

PROTECT HOMES AND NEIGHBOURHOODS

Flood resilience and drainage

A plan to investigate repeated flooding, reduce avoidable risks and keep residents informed.

300+ mm

RAIN ACROSS JULY 21–AUG. 2, 2026

\$20 million

CITY-APPROVED EMERGENCY FLAP FUNDING



WARD 5 NEIGHBOURHOOD STREET | CONTEXT ONLY: NOT A PHOTOGRAPH OF FLOOD DAMAGE

Why this cannot wait

The 2026 storms damaged homes and overwhelmed infrastructure across St. Catharines. Flooding can involve multiple pathways, including overland runoff, groundwater, sanitary backups and stormwater limitations. Residents need credible investigations—not a single unproven explanation for every affected basement.

What I will advocate

- A coordinated review of flood complaints, sewer and drainage conditions, maintenance records and known problem locations.
- Risk-based prioritization of stormwater and sewer rehabilitation, including neighbourhood-scale solutions where engineering supports them.
- Better communication about available flood-protection programs and claim processes.

How I will pursue it

Ask staff to set out the technical evidence, responsible jurisdiction, estimated cost and funding options for the most serious ward-level drainage risks. Support targeted investigations, practical short-term maintenance and long-term capital planning, with Niagara Region and other partners involved where appropriate.

Review uptake and accessibility of the City's Emergency Flood Alleviation Program. Seek timely, plain-language updates about eligibility, processing, approved projects and work schedules.

How residents will judge progress

A published list of assessed high-risk locations, actions recommended, approved budgets, construction milestones and progress reporting.

Sources: City of St. Catharines July 2026 Flooding Response and Recovery; Emergency Flood Alleviation Program. Rainfall was cumulative, not a single-storm total.

FIX THE SYSTEM, NOT JUST THE SYMPTOM

Infrastructure guided by evidence

Put condition, safety and long-term risk ahead of short-term convenience.



ROAD CONDITIONS DOCUMENTED DURING NEIGHBOURHOOD VISITS

What responsible planning means

Roads, sidewalks, sewers, stormwater facilities and parks are connected systems. Delaying maintenance may reduce an immediate expense while increasing repair costs and disruption later. We need a clear view of condition, service levels and consequences of failure.

My commitments

- Request transparent condition and risk assessments for priority Ward 5 infrastructure.
- Advocate for an integrated list of road, sidewalk and drainage work, identifying potential opportunities to coordinate construction.
- Challenge major development proposals where servicing capacity has not been adequately demonstrated.

Better capital decisions

For significant projects, I will ask what problem is being solved, what alternatives have been considered, how costs were estimated, what the long-term operating burden will be and how residents will be affected.

I will work with the responsible municipal and regional teams to seek available infrastructure grants and align projects where jurisdictions overlap.

What to publish

- Priority and location, condition evidence, proposed solution and estimated lifecycle cost.
- Approved funding, project lead, schedule, scope changes and actual completion status.
- Reasons for deferrals and any interim risk controls.

My principle: Infrastructure decisions should be grounded in engineering evidence, asset condition and long-term risk—not simply in what can be postponed.

City asset management and capital budgets are existing public frameworks. The ward-specific review and reporting standards above are campaign proposals.

AFFORDABILITY WITH FISCAL DISCIPLINE

Explore a four-year City tax cap

A funded approach to easing pressure without passing hidden costs to future budgets.

1.74%

2026 INCREASE: CITY PORTION

3.79%

2026 COMBINED TAX INCREASE

The proposal

I support exploring a four-year cap on increases to the City-controlled portion of residential property taxes. This is not a pledge that an entire household tax bill can be frozen: Niagara Region and the Province set other components, and assessments or levies may also affect what residents pay.

A responsible proposal must be evaluated in each annual budget, supported by verifiable and sustainable savings, and not weaken fire protection, snow clearing, infrastructure maintenance or other essential services.

Where savings may exist

- Review recurring administrative costs and overlapping processes.
- Compare contract pricing and competitive purchasing practices.
- Use lawful renewal and renegotiation opportunities where they deliver better value.

How I will pursue it

Request a costed options report identifying the financial effect of freezing or limiting annual increases in the City portion, alongside risks, service implications and possible alternatives. Ask for long-term estimates—not a one-year solution created by emptying reserves.

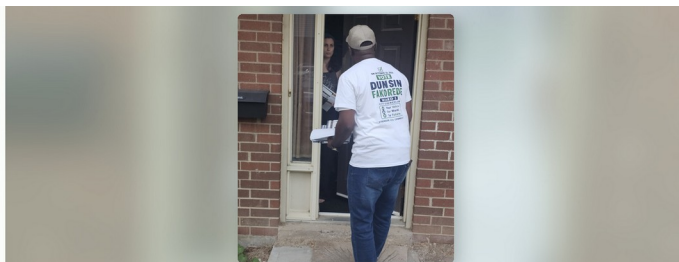
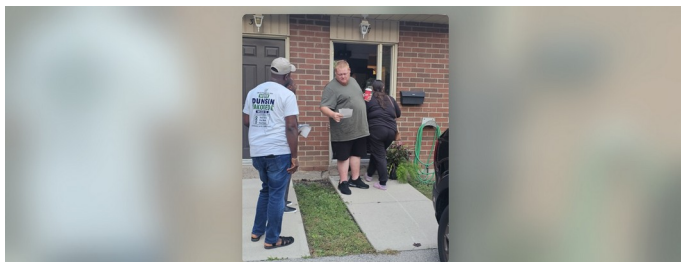
Support business investment and a healthier tax base, while separating uncertain future growth from savings that have actually been secured.

Protect seniors and fixed incomes

Review available tax deferral and assistance tools, improve awareness and explore feasible additional measures for eligible residents in partnership with the relevant authorities.

Measure

Public annual comparison of adopted tax increases, verified savings, service standards, reserve impacts and infrastructure commitments.



AT THE DOORS | LISTENING TO RESIDENTS ABOUT AFFORDABILITY

Source: City of St. Catharines 2026 Tax Payments and Rates. These percentages describe different components and cannot be used interchangeably.

EVERY DOLLAR SHOULD HAVE A PURPOSE

Budget and contract accountability

Residents should know what was approved, what was spent and what was delivered.



LISTENING AT LOCAL EVENTS | COMMUNITY AND BUSINESS CONVERSATIONS

Before spending is approved

My approach to major spending is straightforward: define the problem, examine options, disclose the full life-cycle cost and identify how success will be measured.

- Examine business cases and evidence of long-term operating costs.
- Ask whether procurement achieved fair competition and value.
- Assess whether contracts can be improved at renewal or where changes are lawful and beneficial.
- Scrutinize consulting, change orders and repeated project delays without assuming every expenditure is waste.

After approval: show the results

I will advocate for a plain-language capital reporting dashboard that shows budget versus actual spending, schedule, milestones, accountable department and reasons for material changes.

Where information cannot be published because of lawful confidentiality, I will explain the limitation and seek the strongest appropriate public summary.

Public accountability measures

- Regular explanation of major Ward 5 capital works and service spending.
- Clear project status: proposed, funded, in design, under construction or complete.
- Evidence of savings rather than estimates presented as accomplished results.

Budget discipline should not mean neglecting the infrastructure we already own. It should mean getting measurable value from the money residents entrust to their municipality.

Proposal: expanded project-specific reporting and budget scrutiny. Existing City budgets and financial statements are available through the municipal website.

SAFER STREETS IN EVERY SEASON

Roads, sidewalks and winter safety

Put practical mobility and accessibility into everyday infrastructure decisions.



WINTER MOBILITY AND PEDESTRIAN SAFETY | CANDIDATE PHOTOGRAPHS

A safer way to get around

People should be able to reach schools, bus stops, shops, parks and community facilities safely—whether they drive, walk, cycle, use mobility aids or rely on transit.

- Request a Ward 5 sidewalk and crossing condition assessment.
- Identify speed, visibility and crossing concerns reported by residents.
- Advocate for safer connections to transit stops, schools and community facilities.

Winter mobility

I will bring forward a Ward 5 Priority Snow Clearing Map and seek a review of clearing standards at high-use pedestrian routes. A proposed 24-hour target near schools and bus stops must be assessed for equipment, workforce and funding feasibility before it becomes an enforceable service standard.

Walker's Creek and public spaces

Work with Friends of Walker's Creek, parks staff and residents to pursue a trail safety review and identify high-priority crossings, lighting needs and maintenance concerns.

Support neighbourhood clean-ups, clearer reporting of dumping hotspots and investment in safe, accessible public spaces.

How success will be measured

- Locations reviewed and hazards prioritized.
- Published snow response measures and service levels.
- Projects funded, crossings improved and reported hazards resolved.

Ward 5 snow mapping, trail review and sidewalk condition request are commitments in the candidate's published First 100 Days plan.

RESPECT THE PEOPLE WHO BUILT THIS CITY

Seniors and community connection

Safe mobility, accessible recreation and real opportunities to stay connected.



LISTENING TO OLDER RESIDENTS | COMMUNITY CONVERSATIONS

Listen and respond

Many older residents want to remain in familiar homes and neighbourhoods but face rising costs, difficult winter travel, limited programming and social isolation. Ward 5 should plan services with their needs in mind, not as an afterthought.

- Organize quarterly Ward 5 Senior Connection Day events.
- Seek partnerships for in-home support referrals and a volunteer Friendly Visitor initiative.
- Improve awareness of eligible assistance programs and accessible recreation.
- Advocate for safer sidewalks, crossing points and winter access near community destinations.

Make community facilities work harder

Work with City recreation planners and local users to improve the usefulness and accessibility of Port Weller Community Centre and other available spaces. Explore expanded sports, swim lessons, community programming and an outdoor multi-sport area where feasible.

Use regular resident feedback to ensure facilities and programs serve older adults, families, youth and people with disabilities.

Measure

Events hosted, partners engaged, program participation, accessibility barriers identified and improvements supported by funding.

My commitment to seniors is practical: safer movement, meaningful participation and a respectful voice in every decision that affects their independence.

Proposals are subject to municipal authority, partner participation and approved funding.

A STRONGER WARD FOR EVERY GENERATION

Youth, housing and local jobs

Keep the wider community platform active while we tackle infrastructure and affordability.



CHILDREN, FAMILIES AND WELCOMING PUBLIC SPACES

Young people and skills

Explore a Grantham Tech Hub built through partnerships with the library, Niagara College, Brock University and local mentors. Start with practical digital literacy, career exposure and entry-level workshops rather than promising a costly new facility without funding.

Expand awareness of affordable recreation opportunities and pursue accessible sports programming for families and youth.

Renters belong in the conversation

Support responsive enforcement of property standards, fair access to municipal services and planning policies that encourage suitable rental housing, with infrastructure capacity evaluated before approvals.

Small businesses and employment

Establish a Ward 5 Business Directory and convene regular networking conversations. Ask businesses about unnecessary delays and practical barriers to growth, while supporting responsible redevelopment and employment-generating investment.

Culture and the public realm

Support community events, multicultural programming and better information about existing City grants. Work with residents to keep parks, trails and neighbourhood gathering places safe and welcoming.

Measure

Partnerships formed, events delivered, grant applications assisted, service barriers addressed and local investment opportunities advanced.

These initiatives preserve the substance of the candidate's published ten-commitment platform. Specific funding and delivery depend on partners and approvals.

YOU SHOULD NEVER HAVE TO GUESS

Accountable, accessible leadership

Residents deserve to understand what their councillor is doing on their behalf.

2x / week

PLANNED PUBLIC UPDATE CADENCE

Open channels

EMAIL, PHONE AND RESIDENT MEETINGS

What I will personally do

- Publish regular Ward 5 updates, aiming for Wednesday and Friday communications that are substantive rather than repetitive.
- Explain significant Council votes affecting Grantham and my reasons for supporting or opposing them.
- Remain accessible through campaign-to-office transition, community meetings, email and phone.
- Maintain a public tracker of campaign commitments and ward priorities.
- Attend community functions and listen across age groups, backgrounds and neighbourhoods.

A useful public scorecard

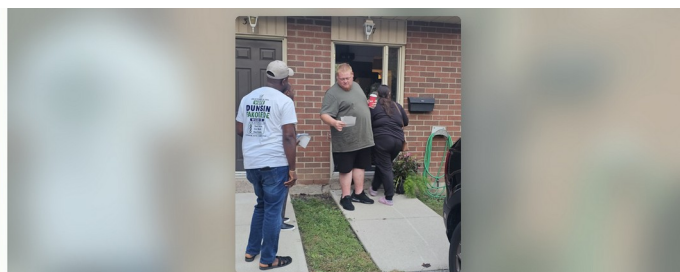
A tracker should name each commitment, the next action, the responsible decision-maker, known funding needs, status and supporting public record. Not all results can be delivered by one councillor; residents should still be able to see whether I pursued the commitment.

When Council says no

I will report setbacks plainly, including why funding was not approved, what alternatives were considered and what step could come next. Accountability is not the claim that every request will pass. It is the willingness to show the work and own the outcome.

Community voice

Host accessible community conversations and make space for seniors, youth, homeowners, renters, businesses and residents who cannot easily attend City Hall.



MEETING RESIDENTS | ACCOUNTABILITY MEANS BEING ACCESSIBLE

Commitments on open communication and tracking progress are proposed practices for the next Council term.

12 ACTIONS, VISIBLE PROGRESS

The first 100 days in office

A practical start: listening, formally raising issues and publishing what has happened.

DAYS 1–30**Listen first. Then act.**

1. Hold a Ward 5 Resident Town Hall.
2. Meet Recreation Facility Plan staff.
3. Meet City department leads.
4. Review outstanding ward service and bylaw concerns.

DAYS 31–60**Make priorities visible.**

1. Table a priority snow-clearing map motion.
2. Seek a Walker's Creek trail safety review.
3. Request a sidewalk and infrastructure assessment.
4. Attend Council and committee meetings.

DAYS 61–100**Lay the groundwork.**

1. Convene the first business networking night.
2. Begin a Senior Connection Day with partners.
3. Request wider visibility for the FAIR program.
4. Publish a public ward progress update.

THE PUBLIC SCORECARD

Each action will show its status, next step and any Council decision or funding requirement. I will distinguish actions initiated from projects approved or completed.

READ THE PLAN. ASK THE QUESTIONS. HOLD ME ACCOUNTABLE.

www.dunsin4stcward5councillor.ca

dunsin4ward5councillor@gmail.com | October 26, 2026



SCAN TO KNOW MORE

Meet Dunsin | Read the platform

www.dunsin4stcward5councillor.ca

Sources for claims: City of St. Catharines (2026 flooding, Emergency FLAP, 2026 tax rates, budget and election pages); Dunsin Fakorede website (platform and First 100 Days). Detailed source and verification register provided separately. Authorized by the Dunsin Fakorede campaign • DF-Media Team.